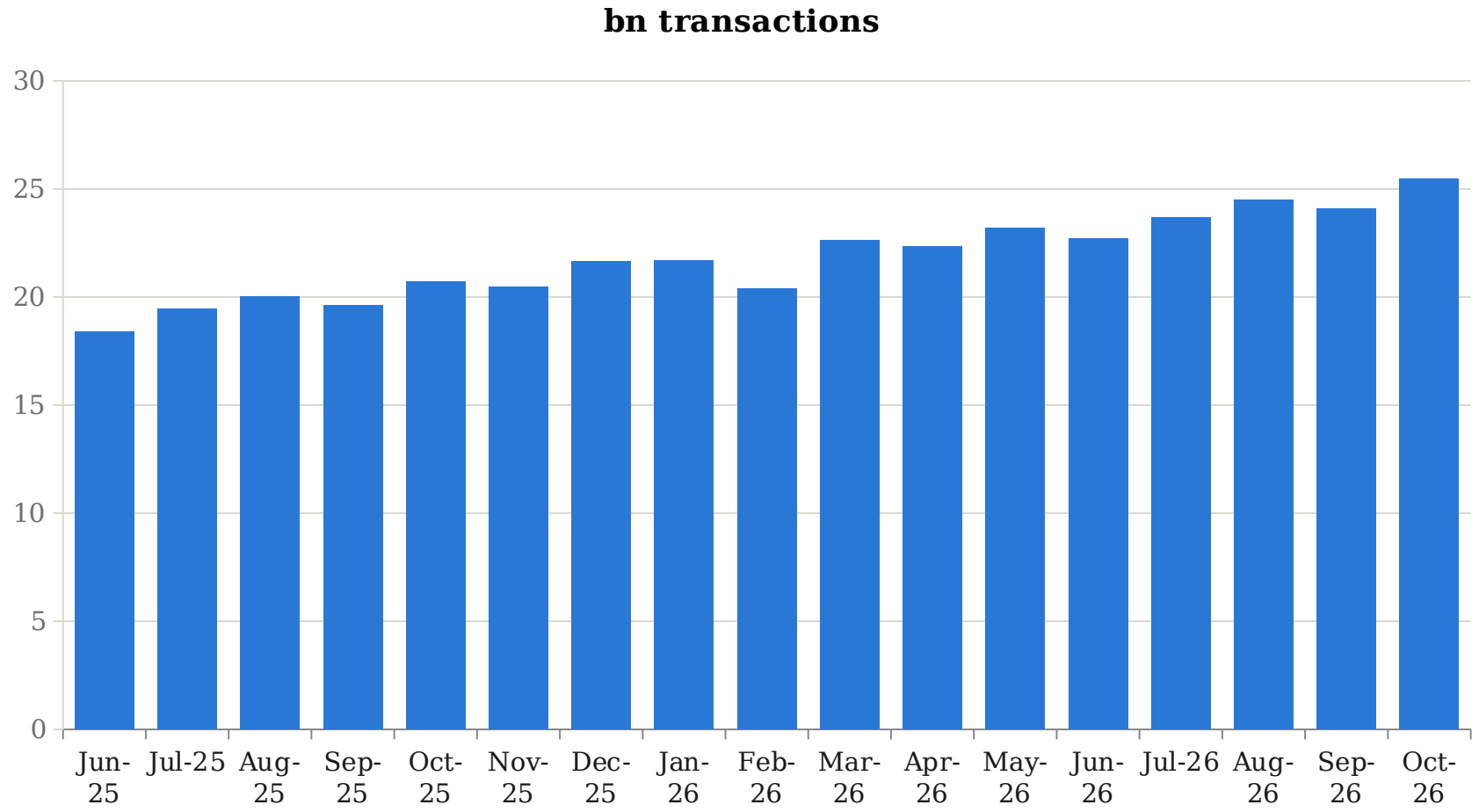
VOLUME

UPI set a new record in Oct-26: 25.47 bn transactions worth Rs 31.53 lakh cr



Avg ticket Rs 1,238 (Oct-26)
Value Rs 31.53 lakh cr

Correction: an earlier draft read a 29-day partial row as the October total.

Source: NPCI UPI product statistics and app-wise statistics; DFS FAQ on MDR (15 Sep 2026); PIB FY26 release (P2M share); Oct-26 full month from NPCI P2P/P2M table via FactIQ

The new MDR creates a Rs 9k-24k cr annual pool from <5% of merchant volume; the range hinges on how much P2M value sits above Rs 2,000

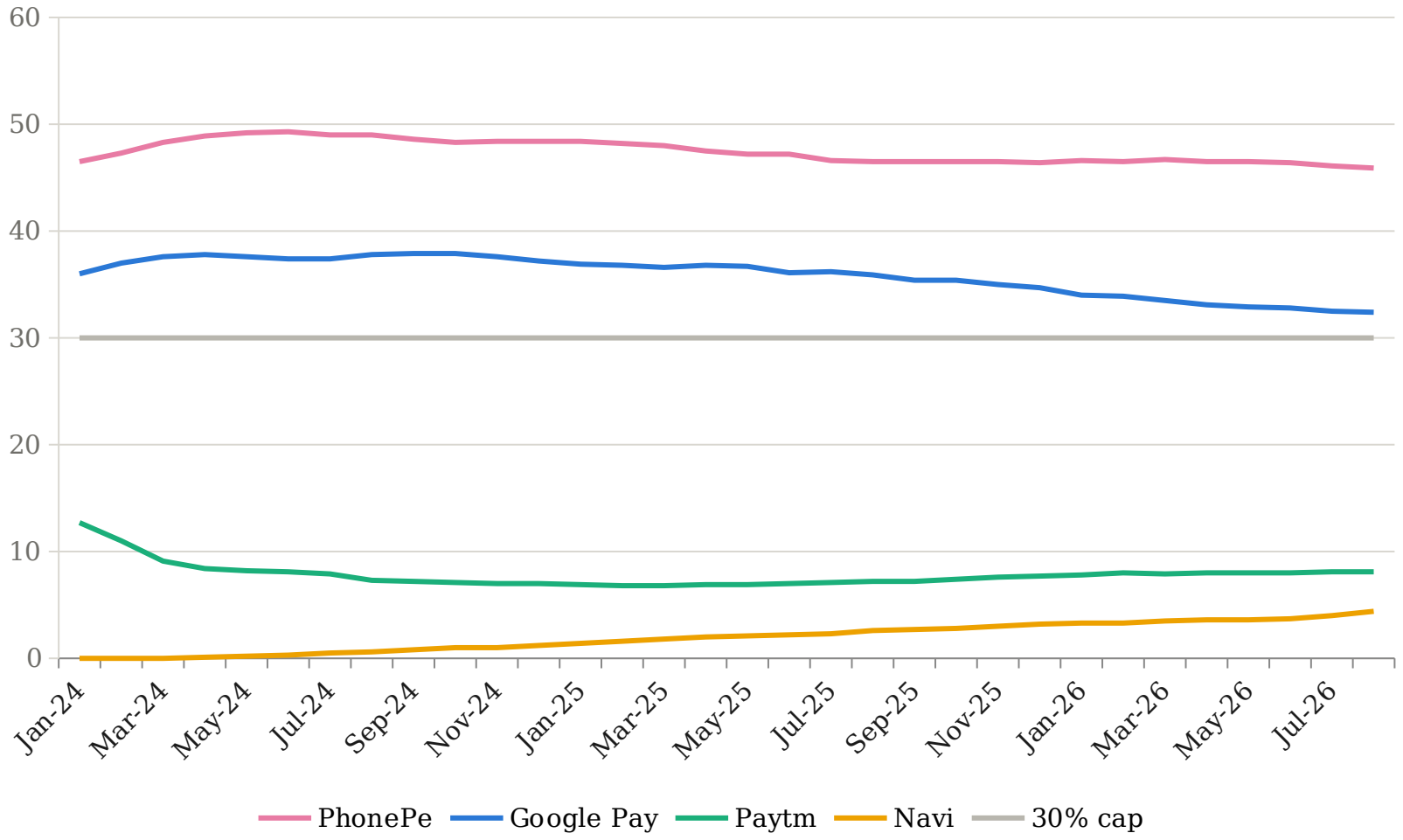
P2M value above Rs 2k \ exempt share	10%	20%	30%	40%
40%	13,784	12,252	10,721	9,189
50%	17,230	15,315	13,401	11,487
60%	20,676	18,379	16,081	13,784
70%	24,122	21,442	18,761	16,081

Rules (DFS FAQ): 0.4% on P2M > Rs 2,000; Rs 300 cap at >= Rs 75,000; Rs 5 flat for railways, telecom, insurance, fuel; P2PM small merchants (<= Rs 1 lakh/month) and AutoPay mandates exempt.

The fee lands on large merchants: a value-driven, concentrated pool.

Source: NPCI UPI product statistics and app-wise statistics; DFS FAQ on MDR (15 Sep 2026); PIB FY26 release (P2M share). Pool = trailing-12m value x 29% P2M x share above Rs 2,000 x (1 - exempt) x 0.4% x 0.95 cap haircut

The 30% cap is out of reach by Dec-26: PhonePe (45.9%) would need to shed 4.0 pp a month; its 12-month trend is -0.03 pp



HHI 3,247 (Aug-26), down from a 3,905 peak as Navi (4.4%) gains.

Likely outcome: another extension or phased glide path rather than hard enforcement on 1 Jan 2027 (judgement).

Source: NPCI UPI product statistics and app-wise statistics; DFS FAQ on MDR (15 Sep 2026); PIB FY26 release (P2M share). Trend = OLS slope of monthly share, last 13 months. Extension is a judgement, not a reported fact